

— CASE STUDY

THREE DAYS TO A

FUTURE-READY PROPERTY

LUCI completed a full retrofit of Ameristar Council Bluffs' AV infrastructure in under three days, modernizing a system that had run since 2012 and centralizing control on land to prepare the property for its next phase of growth.

Ameristar Council Bluffs Casino Council Bluffs, Iowa · Penn Entertainment

AMERISTAR
CASINO • HOTEL
— COUNCIL BLUFFS —

OPERATOR

Penn Entertainment

LOCATION

Council Bluffs, Iowa

RETROFIT COMPLETED

Under 3 days

THE CHALLENGE

A decade-old AV system, aging equipment, and a major casino buildout on the way.

THE APPROACH

A full retrofit in under three days, with all AV processing relocated to the data center on land.

THE RESULT

A unified, scalable platform built for the property's next phase of growth.

A proven system, a bigger future

Ameristar Council Bluffs spans a land-based casino and a riverboat. Its audio-visual system was based on an early LUCI design that had been operating successfully since 2012.

Even after more than a decade of daily use, the original system continued to support property operations and guest experience demands. But the property was preparing for a new chapter: a major casino buildout on the land side and a planned transition away from the riverboat casino.

With years of ongoing upgrades, aging equipment, and that buildout approaching, Ameristar needed a more unified, scalable, and future-ready approach, one that could carry the property through its next phase of growth.



The riverboat at Ameristar Council Bluffs, with the land-side property beyond.

Modernize without disrupting the floor

LUCI's goal was to modernize the property's AV foundation and position it for the transition ahead, without disrupting a floor that runs every day.

The defining move was location. As part of the upcoming transition away from the riverboat casino, LUCI relocated all new AV processing equipment into the property's IT data center on land. Since much of the previous system's processing was located on the boat, this single move eliminated the need to design additional AV rooms into the new buildout, helping reduce future construction and infrastructure costs.

The retrofit installation itself was completed in less than three days. In that window, the team:



Replaced the AV head-end systems, amplifiers, and control infrastructure



Relocated all new AV processing into the property's IT data center



Completed a full conversion and modernization of the system documentation

Consolidation you can see

AV head-end and control hardware

Replaced with a LUCI stack in the land-side data center — less gear to power, cool, and maintain.

Riverboat processing rooms

Processing moved on land so the upcoming buildout does not need new A/V rooms designed into the floor plan.

Separate control workflows

Collapsed into one browser-based interface — unlimited operational users from any authorized device.

Legacy system documentation

Converted to a full LUCI modernization package the team can maintain going forward.

What the property gained

The upgraded LUCI platform now provides unlimited operational users through any browser-based device, giving the property greater flexibility, broader delegation, and faster response times to daily operational needs.

Built-in automation features let the operations team perform daily system resets, scheduled adjustments, and system-wide changes with significantly less hands-on intervention.

And because the property now benefits from LUCI's evolving feature set and software enhancements without additional upgrade licensing costs, the platform continues to grow alongside the casino's future operational and guest experience needs.

01

One unified view of every endpoint

02

Broader delegation by zone

03

Faster response to daily needs

Ameristar on LUCI today

146

Video endpoints

50

Audio zones

78

DTV channels

26

CMS/signage channels



One LUCI platform

Every endpoint, every zone, every channel — one interface.

Built for the moves ahead

With the system centralized on land, the property is set up for what comes next.

- ✓ **The boat can sail.** When the time comes, Ameristar can step away from the riverboat as a clean break, and keep running on LUCI.
- ✓ **The new build can plug in.** When the new construction opens, it runs on the platform already powering the property — no second install, no parallel system to stand up.
- ✓ **Future growth is built in.** As Ameristar expands, it can do so unobstructed — LUCI has removed the logistical variables and A/V complications that would otherwise pile up over time.

By modernizing the AV infrastructure and centralizing system control, LUCI helped Ameristar Council Bluffs prepare for its next phase of growth, preserving operational reliability, improving efficiency, and reducing long-term infrastructure costs.

Curious what this looks like for
your property? Let's talk.

Talk to LUCI →

ABOUT LUCI

LUCI Systems orchestrates every layer of technology running your property — AV, signage, building, and operational infrastructure — from a single interface your team controls from anywhere. Rather than adding layers to your stack, LUCI reduces the variables, hardware, and interfaces your team has to manage. When onsite experience and operational continuity are non-negotiable, LUCI delivers coordinated, real-time execution, end to end.